Stephen A. Wenzel

Raleigh, NC
Cell: (828) 734-4555
stephenawenzel@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/stephenawenzel

Education

Meredith College

Master of Arts in Biomedical Sciences, *August 2026 - May 2027 (Expected)*

The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

B.S. in Biology, Minor in Chemistry and Neuroscience, *August 2018 - May 2022*

Dean's List in Spring 2022

Clinical Experience

Volunteer Ophthalmic Assistant Trainer

ABCCM Medical Ministry | Asheville, NC

January 2026 - July 2026

- Performed ophthalmic screenings and vision assessments for underserved patients, primarily serving a Spanish-speaking population with limited access to insurance and government healthcare programs
- Collaborated with optometrist and volunteer leadership to establish an ophthalmology clinic and develop standardized workflows for patient vision assessments.
- Trained clinic staff to independently operate ophthalmic diagnostic equipment, including autorefractors and Optos retinal imaging systems.
- Developed instructional materials to support staff training, equipment proficiency, and continuity of patient care.

Certified Ophthalmic Assistant

Duke Eye Center - Retina & Glaucoma | Durham, NC

September 2024 - November 2025

- Earned the Certified Ophthalmic Assistant (COA) credential, qualifying for advanced responsibilities including surgical measurements, patient preparation for the inherited retinal disease clinic, and training of new employees.
- Performed comprehensive ophthalmic evaluations supporting up to 9 physicians daily, including OCT imaging, anterior segment examinations, refractions, and visual field testing.
- Administered dilating agents, intraocular pressure-lowering medications, and topical anesthetics under physician supervision.
- Maintained compliance with Joint Commission standards and supported quality assurance initiatives to promote patient safety.

Medical Assistant

Western Carolina Ear, Nose, and Throat Specialists, PLLC | Clyde, NC

August 2023 - June 2024

- Triaged and obtained comprehensive medical histories for 20–25 patients daily during outpatient clinic visits.
- Assisted providers with physical examinations, in-office procedures, specimen collection, and minor surgical procedures.
- Documented patient encounters and maintained accurate electronic health records (EHRs).
- Sterilized instruments and operated autoclaves in accordance with OSHA requirements to support infection prevention and control.

Ophthalmic Assistant

Mountain Eye Associates | Clyde, NC

May 2022 - April 2023

- Performed diagnostic ophthalmic testing, including OCT imaging, refraction, and visual field analysis, for 14–16 patients daily.
- Prepared patients for cataract surgery and in-office laser procedures.
- Administered ophthalmic medications in accordance with physician-directed protocols.

Selected Shadowing Experience

Otolaryngology: Jacob Jennings, PA-C | 176 hours

Western Carolina Ear, Nose, and Throat Specialists, PLLC | Clyde, NC

Ophthalmology: Dr. Pratap Challa, MD; Dr. Stuart McKinnon, MD, PhD | 21 hours

Duke Department of Ophthalmology | Retina & Glaucoma | Durham, NC

Dermatology: Phaedra Hockman, PA-C; Hannah Seville, PA-C | 24 hours

Mountain Laurel Dermatology | Clyde, NC

Family Medicine: Emily Watson, PA-C; Dr. Thomas Ward, MD | 8 hours

Waynesville Family Practice | Waynesville, NC

Ophthalmology: Dr. David Markoff, MD, FACS; Dr. Caroline Denwood, MD | 6 hours

Mountain Eye Associates | Clyde, NC

Research Experience

Undergraduate Research Assistant

The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill - Rogers Laboratory | Chapel Hill, NC

August 2021 - May 2022

- Investigated the effects of cytoskeletal drug treatments on microtubule acetylation and mitochondrial transport in *Drosophila melanogaster*.
- Reviewed scientific literature to guide experimental design and support data interpretation.
- Conducted fluorescence microscopy and generated kymographs to quantify and analyze mitochondrial movement.
- Presented research findings in a scientific poster at the University of North Carolina Undergraduate Research Expo.

Undergraduate Research Assistant

UNC Adams School of Dentistry | Chapel Hill, NC

June 2020 - December 2020

- Conducted systematic literature searches across biomedical and educational databases to investigate competency-based medical education and healthcare professional assessment.
- Screened, organized, and synthesized peer-reviewed literature using standardized inclusion criteria and Microsoft Excel to support consistent qualitative analysis.
- Collaborated with faculty researchers to examine definitions of professional competence and Entrustable Professional Activities (EPAs), contributing to a shared framework for health professions education and admissions.

Teaching & Leadership

Duke MINDs Learn Committee | *June 2025 - November 2025*

- Organized professional development programs and networking events to support career growth and relationship-building among early-career Duke employees.
- Collaborated across departments to plan recurring events that fostered professional development and engagement among hospital staff.

Marching Band Assistant | *Fall Semesters of 2023 and 2024*

- Mentored section leaders and drum majors in leadership development and season-long planning.
- Collaborated with instructors and volunteers to enhance student musical performance, teamwork, and engagement.

Assistant Scoutmaster | *November 2022 - November 2023*

- Mentored more than 20 Scouts in rank advancement and guided multiple candidates through the Eagle Scout advancement process.
- Coordinated monthly with district leadership to support troop development and organize community service projects.

Organic Chemistry II Peer Mentor | *August 2021 - May 2022*

- Mentored more than 20 Scouts in rank advancement and guided multiple candidates through the Eagle Scout advancement process.
- Coordinated monthly with district leadership to support troop development and organize community service projects.

Volunteer Experience

Patient Experience Volunteer | *November 2024 - November 2025*

Duke University Hospital | Durham, NC

- Recipient, 2025 Most Supportive Volunteer Award, Duke University Hospital System.
- Supported two nursing teams in enhancing care and comfort for more than 30 patients across multiple medical-surgical units.
- Welcomed patients and visitors while organizing clinical equipment and maintaining hospital unit resources to support efficient patient care.

Undergraduate COVID-19 Test Site Volunteer | *August 2021 - April 2022*

Carolina COVID-19 Student Services Corps (CSSC) | Chapel Hill, NC

- Directed more than 30 students and staff weekly through onsite COVID-19 testing procedures.
- Collected laboratory specimens and coordinated specimen handling with pathology personnel.
- Communicated testing protocols and public health recommendations to community members to promote understanding and adherence.

Certifications & Honors

Certified Ophthalmic Assistant (COA) | JCAHPO | *active June 2025 - June 2028*

2025 Most Supportive Volunteer | Duke University Hospital| *Received January 2025*

Recipient, Eagle Scout Award | Boy Scouts of America | October 2017